

GREECE 2016

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1. Review of the system

1.1 Average Worker Wage (AW)

The 2016 estimated AW is EUR 20 074.

2. Unemployment Insurance

The unemployment insurance system covers persons who are insured against diseases with a social insurance body and who are insured against unemployment with the Labour Employment Office. The benefits are divided into regular benefits and special allowances. This programme is targeted on employees that became unemployed against their will and are not capable of finding a job relevant to their qualifications.

Program name in local language		Unemployment Insurance (ΤΑΚΤΙΚΗ ΕΠΙΔΟΤΗΣΗ ΑΝΕΡΓΙΑΣ)
Insurance is voluntary(V) or compulsory(C) for employees		C
Employment record (E) and contribution (C) conditions		E + C: 125 working days in last 14 months or 200 days in last two years and for first time unemployed 80 days per year in the last two years
Waiting period (days)		6
Maximum duration (months)		12
Uprating mechanism of the benefit		Decided by the Government, based on the daily wage of a blue-collar worker
Calculation of unemployment insurance benefit:	initial benefit as % of calculation base	Flat rate of monthly EUR 360 (55% of unskilled worker wage) for prior full-time employed (different for part-time with low income)
	benefit at the end of legal entitlement period in % of calculation base	Same as initial benefit
	Calculation base	n.a.
	Permitted employment and disregards when receiving unemployment insurance benefit	No
Benefit provision (eligibility (E), generosity (G)) varies with	age	n.a.
	family situation	G: + 10% for every dependent family member of beneficiary
	contract type	n.a.
	other	n.a.

2.1 Condition for receipt

- The person must be capable of and available for work;
- The person must be unemployed unwillingly;
- The person must have registered with an employment agency;
- The person must not receive a pension equal to or larger than the minimum pension granted by IKA (Social Insurance Institute);
- The person must not be self-employed.

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Under art.44, para2, of L. 3986/2011 a Special Fund for the Self-Employed was established, which will provide a special assistance in cases of proven ending of an occupation and for at least three months. For the actual implementation of this Special Fund, a decision of the Minister of Labour and Social Security, after consultation with the Board of Directors of agencies and opinion of Council for Social Security (S.K.A.) is needed.

2.1.1 Employment conditions

The persons applying for the benefit for the **first time** must have worked for at least 80 days per year in the last two years prior to their application and should also have

- 125 days of employment in the last 14 months prior to applying for the benefit (the last two months prior to the commencement of unemployment are not taken into consideration in the calculation of these 125 working days), or
- 200 days of employment in the last 2 years prior to the dismissal (the last two months prior to the commencement of unemployment are not taken into consideration in the calculation of these 200 working days)

A person applying for the **second time** must satisfy the following condition: a contribution record of 125 working days in the last 14 months prior to his/her dismissal (the last two months prior to the commencement of unemployment are not taken into consideration in the calculation of these 125 working days). As for the employees in the tourism sector (or seasonal workers, e.g. musicians, actors), the following conditions must be satisfied:

- 100 working days in the last 12 months prior to the dismissal if the employee worked for two consecutive touristic seasons (the last two months prior to the commencement of unemployment are not taken into consideration). 100 working days in the last 14 months prior to the dismissal if the employee worked for one touristic season (the last two months prior to the commencement of unemployment are not taken into consideration). The same condition applies also for the construction workers.

As for those in the tourism sector (or seasonal workers, e.g. musicians, actors), applying for the first time they must also have worked for at least 80 days per year in the last two years prior to their application.

2.1.2 Contributions conditions

The system is contributory. The contributions made to the OAED (Manpower Employment Organization) are paid both by the employer and the employee.

2.2 Calculation of benefit amount

2.2.1 Calculation of gross benefit

Pursuant to article 5 of Act 3352/07 for the unemployed that were employed in a full-time job or whose monthly wages were higher than the twelve-fold of the daily wage of the unskilled worker, the basic unemployment benefit is defined to 50% of the daily wage of the unskilled worker from January 1st 2007 and from January 1st 2008 to 55% of the daily wage of the unskilled worker.

To the unemployed that were not employed in a full-time job and whose monthly wages were lower than or equal to the six-fold of the daily wage of the unskilled worker, 50% of the basic unemployment benefit is paid, whereas to the unemployed that were not employed in a full-time job

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and whose monthly wages were higher than the six-fold and lower than or equal to the twelve-fold of the daily wage of the unskilled worker, 75% of the basic unemployment benefit is paid.

Following the decline of the daily wage of the unskilled worker by 22% (art.1, para6, L.4046/2012) the basic daily unemployment benefit decreased also, from 12 March 2012, and currently it amounts to 14,40 euros, while the monthly unemployment benefit to 360,00 euros (Ministerial Decision 3800/359/1.3.2012).

The lowest daily unemployment benefit is 7,20 euros and the monthly 180,00 euros.

The unemployment benefit is paid for 25 days per month and increases by 10% for every dependant member of the beneficiary.

2.2.2 *Income and earnings disregards*

None. The payment of the benefit is interrupted in case there is an income from commercial businesses or liberal professions.

2.3 *Tax treatment of the benefit*

The unemployment benefit paid by the OAED to the beneficiaries, is tax exempt on condition that the sum of the taxpayer's other income, which is taxable under the general provisions, does not exceed EUR 10.000 annually.

2.4 *Benefit duration*

The benefit is paid after a waiting period of six days.

The period during which the unemployment benefit is being paid depends upon the contribution record the applicant establishes before becoming unemployed and varies between 5 and 12 months, as follows:

TABLE 1 (GENERAL CATEGORY)

Days of employment (14 th -month period)	Construction workers (14 th -month)	Duration (months)
125-149 ¹	100-149	5
150-179 ²	150-179	6
180-219 ³	180-219	8
220-249	220-249	10
250 or more	250 or more	12
210 days and 49 + years old	210 days and 49 + years old	12
1. or 200 in the 2-year period		
2. or 250 in the 2-year period		
3. or 300 in the 2-year period		

TABLE 2 (TOURISM SECTOR)

Days employment (12 th -month period)	of Specifications relating to law provisions		Duration (months)
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(100-149 days of employment)	(compulsory subjection to art.26, L.4203/2013)	100-149	3 months and 5 days (exemption from the limitation of 400 daily unemployment benefits within the previous four years)
(150-230 days of employment)	1 st category (with a solemn declaration of the worker for his subjection to art.26, L.4203/2013)*	150-230	3 months and 5 days (exemption from the limitation of 400 daily unemployment benefits within the previous four years)
	2 nd category (no solemn declaration - the limitation of 400 daily unemployment benefits within the previous four years remains)	150-179	6 months
		180-219	8 months
		220-230	10 months
(231 and more days of employment)	231 and more (workers not subject to the provisions of art. 26, L. 4203/2013)	231-249	10 months
		250 and more	12 months

From 1 January 2013, the daily unemployment benefits within the previous four year unemployment period before each entry to the grant of unemployment cannot be more than four hundred and fifty (450) daily benefits. If within four years the unemployed person has been subsidized for a period of less than four hundred and fifty (450) daily benefits he/she shall be entitled to subsidized unemployment for the rest of the number of daily benefits, until the completion of maximum four hundred fifty (450) daily allowances.

From 1 January 2014, daily unemployment benefits in four years cannot be more than four hundred (400) daily benefits.

3. Unemployment Assistance

Programme name in local language		Special aid for the unemployed (BOHΘHMATA ANEPTIAΣ)
Employment record (E) and contribution (C) conditions and relationship to unemployment insurance benefits (UI)		UI
Waiting period (days)		...
Maximum duration (months)		...
Uprating mechanism of the benefit		...
Calculation of unemployment assistance benefit:	initial benefit as % of calculation base	EUR 200 per month
	benefit at the end of legal entitlement period in % of calculation base	EUR 200 per month
	Calculation base	n.a.
	Permitted employment and disregards when receiving unemployment assistance benefit	No
Benefit provision (eligibility (E), generosity (G)) varies with	age	G: +/- paid at a lower rate to young (20-29) for 5 months on condition that registered unemployed
	family situation	n.a.
	contract type	n.a.
	other	n.a.

3.1 Special aids (Conditions and duration)**3.1.1 Long-term unemployed people (in force from 1 January 2014)**

The aim of this benefit is to provide financial assistance to long-term unemployed aged 20-66. Unemployed who have received the unemployment benefit for 12 months apply for the Benefit for the Long Term Unemployed within 2 months after the expiration of the Unemployment benefit. Applicants must be registered with the OAED for a minimum of 12 months and the annual family income must not exceed the amount of 10.000 Euros (increased by 586.08 Euros for each dependent child under the age of 18).

The benefit amounts to 200€ and is paid for twelve months (at most).

The increase of 10% by each dependent person is given only to the “special aid” recipients and not to the recipients of the “long-term unemployed people benefit”.

Beneficiaries should not fall into the category of art.22 of Law No1836/89 beneficiaries (construction workers, singers, etc.).

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Under the national legislation beneficiaries are only Greek and EU nationals are eligible for this allowance.

3.1.2 Special aid after the end of payment of the unemployment allowance

A special allowance, which comprises of 13 basic daily wages of the unemployment benefit (it amounts to 14,4€), is paid to the unemployed who are not temporarily employed following the end of payment of the unemployment benefit, on condition that they remain unemployed and their family income does not exceed a fixed amount (10.858,40 € for 2016). This special allowance amounted to $14,4 \times 13 = 187,2\text{€}$.

In order to receive this allowance the unemployed person should not fall into the category of 22 of L. N. 1836/89 beneficiaries (construction workers, singers, etc.).

3.1.3 Special aid after a three-month registration in the unemployed persons list

It is paid to the unemployed, who do not have the prerequisites for a regular benefit (not seasonal workers) and have actually worked for at least 60 days in the year prior to that in which they registered with the OAED. These persons must remain unemployed (registered with the OAED) for 3 months. The benefit is paid every three months in three separate instalments in the same year. The payment consists of 15 daily wages of the unemployment benefit, on condition that their family income does not exceed a fixed amount (10.858,40€ for 2016).

3.1.4 Other special benefits – Short-time work benefit

In case of work suspension (usually occurs when a company is financially weak), unemployed people receive by OAED assistance for the period under suspension. This assistance is equal to 10% of the average regular earnings recorded in the last two months of full time employment prior to work suspension.

These benefits are not paid for longer than three months per year. It is not possible to grant a benefit repeatedly.

3.2 Income and earnings disregards

None.

3.3 Tax treatment of benefit and interaction with other benefits

No taxation is imposed on special allowances.

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3.4 Treatment of particular groups

3.4.1 Young persons

The benefit is granted to young persons (aged 20-29), on condition they are unemployed and remain registered as unemployed for one year. The benefit amounts to 73,37€ per month and is paid for a period of five months. It aims to support the new entrants into the labour market.

3.4.2 Seasonal aid

This aid is offered to persons belonging to occupational groups employed on a seasonal basis (construction workers, tobacco workers, actors, tile makers, forest workers, musicians, etc.). The aid is paid on a yearly basis in the period from the 10th of September till the 30th of November (under Law 3762/2009). The following prerequisites must be fulfilled:

- The applicant must have actually worked for 50 – 210 days, as the case may be in the pertinent branch in the year prior to the year of payment.
- The applicant must not have actually worked for more days in branches other than the pertinent one in the previous year.
- The total of daily wages in any work must not exceed 240.
- The applicant must not fulfil the preconditions for regular benefit in the period in which the seasonal aid is paid.

3.4.3 Worker laid off due to insolvency of the employer

The OAED keeps an independent account called “Account for the protection of workers against employers’ insolvency”. This account aims to pay up to three months earnings unpaid, due to the employer’s insolvency, as provided for in a contract of employment or a dependent working relationship. These earnings are considered and are being taxed as paid services.

3.4.4 Unemployment benefit due to refrain from work

The aim of this benefit is to compensate financially the employee who exercises his/ her right to refrain from work because the employer has stopped granting the wages and has the same eligibility criteria that apply for the unemployment benefit.

For the employees not entitled to the unemployment benefit, an unemployment allowance can be given. Beneficiaries eligible are insured people in the event of business failure and for any reason terminate the employment contract by the employer, or in case of the employee’s right of refrain from work (Article 325 AK).

The amount of the allowance is equal to 20 times the basic unemployment allowance, valid on the date of application for granting of the aid, plus 10% for each protected member, on condition that the beneficiary’s family income does not exceed a fixed amount (10.858,40 for 2016).

3.4.5 Unemployment allowance to the self-employed persons and liberal professionals (OAEE, ETAP – MME)

The aim of this benefit is to compensate financially the persons who have ceased their business. Beneficiaries are persons formerly insured by OAEE and ETAP –MME who have ceased business from 01/01/2012 onwards, do not work (either as self-employed or employees), do not have

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outstanding debts to their Social Security Fund or have settled their outstanding debts (Ministerial Decision F10035/Oik.1239/63/2014, O.G.290/B/10-02-2014), do not receive a pension, from 01/01/2011 onwards have paid contributions to the Special Account for Unemployment for the above mentioned insured persons.

The amount of the allowance is fixed at 360,00 € per month and should not be increased depending on the number of dependents of the beneficiary's family, nor the payment of any holiday benefits or return of contributions to the appropriate insurance carrier during payment of the allowance. The duration varies from 3 up to a maximum of 9 months.

4. Social assistance

4.1 EKAS (social solidarity benefit for pensioners)

It is a non-contributory monthly benefit, providing financial support to receivers of old-age, invalidity or survivors' pensions. [The scheme was first introduced in 1996 (Law 2434)]. This allowance is financed by the State Budget.

Law 3996/05.08.2011 on the restructuring of the Labour Inspectorate (SEPE) provides information on EKAS (**Article 34** – redefining the EKAS eligibility conditions). The recently passed Law 4387/2016, article 92 on EKAS and the encyclical circulated by the General Secretariat of Social Security on 1st of June 2016 provide analytical information on the above mentioned benefit.

Conditions that must be met cumulatively by the pensioners in order to receive the EKAS:

- Old-age and survivors pensioners must be of at least 65 years of age (pensioners with disability of 80% and above and children who receive pension due to the death of the parent, do not need to meet the age conditions).
- The total net annual income from pensions (main pensions, supplementary pensions and benefits), salaries, wages and other allowances may not exceed EUR 7.972.
- The total annual individual taxable income may not exceed EUR 8.884.
- The total annual family taxable income may not exceed EUR 11.000.
- The total gross pension (main and supplementary) paid may not exceed EUR 664.
- Pensioners should reside permanently in Greece.

The payable amount of EKAS is as follows:

Amount of Income	Amount of EKAS (in Euros) per month
Up to 7.216 euros	230.00
7.216– 7.518 euros	172.50
7.518 – 7.720 euros	115.00
7.720 – 7.972 euros	57.50
More than 7.972 euros*	30.00

*The total annual family taxable income may not exceed EUR 11.000.

EKAS is granted to all pensioners who receive pension on the date of publication of the Law 4387/2016 and are integrated into EFKA funds for main pension (except OGA), as well as pensioners of Bank of Greece.

4.2 Treatment of particular groups

4.2.1 Programmes to support persons with disabilities - Non-institutional Benefit

There is no general framework, but there are provisions for persons in great need. The Ministry of Labour, Social Security and Social Solidarity implements 10 programmes of financial support for persons with disabilities depending on the kind, the category or the seriousness of the disability.

Furthermore, in accordance with the provisions of Act No1140/1981 and Joint Ministerial Decision No 61384/6138/19-5-1983 of the Ministers of Defence, Interior, Justice, Finance, Health and Social Solidarity and of Public Order, as amended and in force, active employees of Local Self-Government Agencies suffering from quadriplegia or paraplegia as well as their family members suffering from the same diseases are entitled to a non-institutional benefit paid by either the body which is the employer of the beneficiary (Local Self-Government Agency) or by the insurance body of the beneficiary.

In order for the Local Self-Government Agency to grant this benefit, the following preconditions are necessary: a) the beneficiary is an active employee, b) the beneficiary does not receive a benefit from another source and c) the beneficiary is not hospitalized. The benefit is granted from the LSGA's budget. For the quadriplegic and the paraplegic persons insured in the public sector, the benefit in 2011 amounted to 742 euro.

In addition, concerning the social security funds under the competence of the General Secretariat for Social Security there are the following provisions for persons with disabilities: Totally blind persons and insured persons suffering from certain diseases, who accomplished 4,050 days of contributions, receive pension corresponding to 10,500 working days regardless of their age. Benefit for non-residential care is a monthly benefit provided to insured persons, old-age, invalidity and survivor's pensioners, in case they do not receive the Total invalidity benefit, as well as to their family members if they suffer from specific diseases and meet certain conditions. The insured person must have completed: the days of work that are required for acquiring sickness benefits in kind, during the year of the application (100 days as of 1/1/2013 and beyond) and at least 350 days of insurance during the 4 last years before the invalidity, or 10,000 days of insurance in total. The amount granted corresponds to 20 times the wage of an unskilled worker (€33.57) i.e. €671.

4.2.2. Food allowance (Law No.4320/Article 3)

Food allowance for the year 2016 is granted to individuals and families living in conditions of extreme poverty. For the granting of food allowance, the total income of the allowances coming from each source is being taken into account. Income does not include revenue such as, but not limited to, the disability allowances granted by the State. Food allowance is provided with a prepaid card for the supply of food species. This provision has been extended till 31/01/2017 by virtue of article 55 of Law 4449/2017 (O.G.7/A). A family could receive the allowance for a period of 19 months.

5. Housing benefits

Regular housing benefits	Programme name in local language		Rent allowance (ΕΠΙΔΟΜΑ ΕΝΟΙΚΙΟΥ)
	Entitlement depends on	Household type/size	Yes
		Income	Yes
		Dwelling size	No
		Geographic location	No
		Actual rental cost	No
	Description of regular housing benefit		means-tested benefit that is granted to low-income families who rent a house as their main residence; the amount increases with number of family members
	Uprating mechanism of the benefit		...
Housing related support through other benefits		Various schemes for specific groups: housing allowance paid to tertiary education undergraduates, housing assistance for elderly over 65	

5.1 Rent Benefit to Secure Housing (Law 4320/2015 (Article 2))

Rent benefit is granted to a maximum of 30,000 people and families living in extreme conditions of poverty and which do not have any accommodation capacity in a private property in their permanent residence.

This provision applies to new leases or renewals of existing leases with new terms after the entry into force of Act No 4320/2015 and will be administered directly to the landlord of the rented property. The benefit is granted for the year 2015 and till the end of the year 2016, under the conditions laid down in this Article.

The monthly benefit amount is €70 for single-person increased by €30 for each additional member up to a maximum of €220 per month. It is a means-tested benefit given to low-income tenants on a monthly basis. It is not taxed.

The income which is assessed comprises the taxable income of the family unit, all taxable pensions and benefits received excluding disability benefits, minus income taxes and social insurance contributions. The annual income threshold is €2,400 for single-person tax units increased by €1,200 for each additional adult and by €600 for each dependent minor of the tax unit. The upper limit of the annual income threshold is €6,000 per year. Additionally, in a lone-parent family unit, the first dependent minor is counted as an adult thus the annual income threshold increases by €1,200 instead of €600. If the assessed income is equal or higher than the threshold, the benefit is fully withdrawn.

The amount of the rent subsidy is tax free, is not subject to any kind of deductions, nor offset with proven debts to credit institutions and is not included in the income threshold for payment of EKAS or any other benefit of social or welfare character. The subsidy amount can be offset against established and regulated debts to the State and their insurance bodies.

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The programme continues until 31/12/2016 by virtue of article 46 of Law 4403/2016 (O.G.125A). A family could receive the allowance for a period of 18 months.

5.2 Treatment of special groups, including disabled

5.2.1. Housing Assistance Programme for elderly persons over 65

The Ministry of Labour, Social Security and Social Solidarity implements the housing assistance programme for single, uninsured and financially weak elderly persons over the age of 65 as well as for couples of uninsured and financially weak elderly persons for whom it has been proven that they do not own a house and live in rented accommodation. The housing allowance is paid in the form of rent.

The term elderly comprises all persons of 65 years of age or older. The beneficiaries can be either single elderly persons, i.e. persons who live alone, or couples of elderly persons who live alone. In the case of couples, at least one of them must have completed the age of 65. In each case the beneficiaries must:

a) be uninsured, i.e. they must not receive pension from any insurance body, with the exception of elderly persons who, according to the provisions of Law 1296/82 and of article 17 of Law 1422/84, receive the pension granted to uninsured persons through the special fund of the Agricultural Insurance Institute (OGA) and can be entitled to housing assistance.

b) be financially weak, according to the provisions of Legislative Decree No 57/73, and must not have any income coming from any domestic or foreign source or any real estate sufficient to cover for their housing needs.

c) Do not own house and live in a rented accommodation.

The program is implemented by the department or the section of Social Welfare of the competent Municipality. In addition to the necessary documentation that should be presented by the would-be beneficiaries, a report written by a social worker of the competent Social Welfare Department mentioning the socioeconomic status of the uninsured elderly person together with a proposal of whether he/she should be entitled or not to receive housing assistance are also required.

For those who are deemed to be beneficiaries, the benefit is paid to the owners of the residences themselves, following the signing of a private agreement between the social welfare service of the competent Municipality and the owner. The amount of the monthly benefit is determined each time by a ministerial decision. According to Ministerial Decision No P3a/F.18/G.P. 63731 (O.G.931/B/21-05-2008), this amount was up to 362 Euros for the year 2011. There has been no alteration to the amount of the benefit since 2011.

The elderly beneficiaries do not pay tax on this housing assistance benefit. The owners of the residences are taxed on their incomes according to the provisions that apply for all taxpayers.

5.2.2 Housing assistance program for homeless persons

Article 1 paragraph A.2 of Law N.4254/2014 (O.G.85A') provides for the funding of actions relating to housing, food and social support services for homeless persons. In the context of the above law, a housing assistance program is implemented in order to cover the basic needs of homeless persons in combination with actions relating to their occupational reintegration. This program is targeted to the following categories of beneficiaries:

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- Families and persons who are accommodated in social shelters for homeless persons or night shelters or persons who make use of the Day Centres for Homeless
- Families and persons who are registered as homeless by the social services of Municipalities
- Women hosted in Shelters for Women Victims of Violence
- Persons hosted in Child Protection Structures, who have reached the age of 18 and are not students

The aforementioned programme for the provision of housing, food and social support services to homeless persons by virtue of article 1, paragraph A.2 of Law 4254/2014 (O.G.85/A'), has been extended by virtue of article 71 of Law 4445/2016 (O.G. 236/A) until 31.12.2017.

The provisions of the program regarding housing and basic needs' coverage (Law N.4254/2014) are the following:

Rent coverage for a period of one year	Up to the amount of 180 euro for one person, up to 240 euro for two adults on a monthly basis	Up to the amount of 280 euro for a family on a monthly basis
Costs of repairing existing residences	Up to the amount of 3.600 euro	Up to the amount of 3.600 euro
Expenses on household appliances and furniture, basic clothing needs, public utilities, etc.	Up to the amount of 1.500 euro	Up to the amount of 2.000 euro
Expenditure on everyday needs (including food and transportation cards)	Up to the amount of 200€ on a monthly basis	Up to the amount of 250 euro on a monthly basis

The subsidy lasts for up to 1 year (Law N.4254/2014) and has been extended till 31/12/2017.

5.2.3 Free reconnection and power supply (Act 4320/Article 1)

Individuals and families living in conditions of extreme poverty, for the year 2016, are provided with free amount of electricity to the main house to 300kwh month. In cases of beneficiaries whose provision of electricity adjourned until the 31/01/2016, there is free provision at no charge, and the arrears are being settled. This monetary value shall not be counted towards fulfilling the conditions of any other provision of social or welfare character based on income criteria. An agreement conducted by the Ministry of Labour, Social Security and Social Solidarity and the providers of electricity defines the terms and conditions of the arrears. This provision was extended till 31/12/2016 by virtue of article 46 of Law 4403/2016 (O.G.125/A).

5.2.4 Housing allowance for tertiary education undergraduates

This housing allowance is within the responsibility of the Ministry of Education and Religious Affairs.

Tertiary education undergraduates are granted an annual housing allowance (Ετήσιο στεγαστικό επίδομα) of 1.000€, in accordance with the provisions of article 10 Act No.3220/04, as it has been amended and it is effective. The allowance is paid for as long as the studies last, according to the course of studies. Tertiary education graduates, who attend a course aiming at obtaining a second or a

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Master's degree, are not entitled to the above allowance, irrespective of how they have been admitted to the course.

There is no specific age limit for a beneficiary, in order to be entitled to the allowance, provided that the legal preconditions are met. The student must reside in a rented house, which, due to his/ her studies, is in a city other than the one of his/her main residence, where neither his parents nor he/ she have the full ownership or the usufruct of another residence. Those who reside in university student halls and boarding houses are not entitled to the allowance. In order for the allowance to be granted, the annual family income of the previous fiscal year must not exceed the amount of 30.000 Euro, increased by 3.000 Euro for each dependent child, beyond the first one.

The housing (student) allowance of 1.000 euros granted annually under the provisions of article 10 of Act No. 3220/2004, cannot be not seized, is granted in full without any deduction in favour of the State or a third party and is not subject to taxation.

6. Family support

Program name (local name in parentheses if available)			1. Single child support allowance 2. Special benefit for families with at least three children	Low income support for families with children in compulsory education and in no case after completing the 24 th year if they attend higher education.	Additional family benefit for large families (3 or more children)
Type of benefit			Targeted	Targeted	Targeted
Eligibility criteria	Age limits for children up to and including (in parentheses if student)		18 or 19 enrolled in compulsory education and up to 24 enrolled in higher education	18 or 19 enrolled in compulsory education and up to 24 enrolled in higher education	18 or 19 enrolled in compulsory education and up to 24 enrolled in higher education
	Other conditions for receipt of benefit (including requirements for conditional cash transfers (CCT))		1. Single child support allowance taking account of the number of children, the equivalence scale, the equivalent income and the equivalence category. 2. Special benefit for families with at least three children It is based on total family income	No	Families with three or more children
Uprating mechanism of the benefit			...	...	...
Benefit amount	Benefit amount per child varies with (where +: positively; 0: no	Age of child	0	0	0

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	influence; -: negatively; --: fixed amount per family)	Number of children	0	0	0
	Earnings disregard		No	No	No
	Withdrawal rate		Gradually reduced by 1/3 as income thresholds of 6000EUR, 12000EUR and 18000EUR	Fully withdrawn if family income above EUR3000	Fully withdrawn if family income above EUR45000 (the threshold increases if more than 3 children)
	Assets part of means test?		...	...	...

6.1 *Single child support allowance*

(OGA) Law 4093/2012 (O.G.222/A/2012) as amended and in force, provides for a ‘single child support allowance’, «ENIAIO EΠΙΔΟΜΑ ΣΤΗΡΙΞΗΣ ΤΕΚΝΩΝ», which shall be paid taking into account the number of dependent children, the equivalence scale, the equivalent income and the income category of the family. In accordance with the above law, the allowance shall be granted to families for every child (i.e. from the first child) and shall amount to forty (40) euro per month for every dependent child (Law 4144/2013 [O.G.88/A/2012]).

Full or part of the allowance is provided to families according to specific income criteria.

Household member	Equivalence Scale
Adult	1
Partner	1/3
Per child	1/6

Income limit (EUR)	Benefit paid
6000	Full
12000	2/3
18000	1/3

6.2 *Special benefit for families with at least three children*

The special allowance of 500€ for each child per year (ΕΙΔΙΚΟ ΕΠΙΔΟΜΑ ΤΡΙΤΕΚΝΩΝ ΚΑΙ ΠΟΛΥΤΕΚΝΩΝ), is established (Law 4141/2013/ O.G. 81A') as an additional benefit for families who have three dependent children or more, based on family income criteria.

Number of children	Benefit paid
3	45000
4	48000
More than 4	+4000 per child

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6.3 Support of unprotected children scheme

Benefit for unprotected children (ΕΠΙΔΟΜΑ ΑΠΟΨΤΑΤΕΥΤΩΝ ΠΑΙΔΙΩΝ) is a monthly benefit of 44,02 € which is paid to each unprotected child up to age of 16, provided that the monthly income of the family that the child is living with does not exceed the amount of 234,77€ for a three-member family (this amount increases by 20,54€ for each member of the family beyond the third one). This benefit is granted to the following cases:

- Children left orphans of both parents;
- Children left orphans of their father;
- Children whose father cannot respond to their subsistence and upbringing needs due to physical or mental disability (67% and more), suffering from diseases that are indicated in detail at art. 1, P.D. 108/83, moral demerit, abandonment, imprisonment, military service, AIDS;
- Children born outside of marriage and exposed.

This “unprotected child allowance [Law 4051/1960 (OG 68, A’)]” is paid by municipalities.

Financial assistance is not provided to unprotected children found in institutions that provide free of charge services and care and operate all year round at a 24-hour basis.

In addition, unprotected children scheme (articles 2 and 3 of Law 4051/1960, OG68/A) has been replaced by article 57 of Law 4472/19-5-2017 (OG74/A). By virtue of the abovementioned law the beneficiaries of the unprotected children scheme are potential beneficiaries of the social solidarity income provided for by Law 4389/2016 (OG94/A’).

6.4 Employer provided family support

Employers in some sectors pay workers (married or not) family support in a form of 5% supplement to the gross income for each child and adding 10% for the spouse. The amount paid for the spouse is independent of her status of employment and income.

6.5 Family allowance for the public sector

Public servants of General Government entities are provided with a family allowance (article 15 of Law 4354/2015, which replaced article 17 of Law 4024/2011). This provision is granted monthly depending on the beneficiaries’ family status as follows:

For an employee with unmarried and under-aged children or children incapable of work (at a rate of disability of at least 50%) or children studying in secondary (up to the age of 19), or higher education (up to the age of 24), the provision granted is set at 50 Euros for one child, 70 Euros in total for two children, 120 Euros in total for three children, 170 Euros in total for four children and is increased by 70 Euros for every additional child.

Ministry General Secretaries are not provided with the abovementioned family allowance.

Moreover, this family allowance is granted to the pensioners of the public sector who have retired from service from 1-11-2011 onwards (sixth case, paragraph 2, article 1 of Law 4024/2011, as amended by paragraph 5, article 1 of Law 4336/2015).

6.6 Other family support schemes

- Low income support for households in mountainous and disadvantaged areas (law 3016/2002, article 27, par.2). An allowance of 600 Euros is granted per year for annual income up to 3.000 Euros and an allowance of 300 Euros per year, for annual income up to 4.700 Euros.
- Low income support for families with children attending compulsory education, i.e. from the age of 5 and not exceeding 16 years of age (law 3016/2002, article 27, par.3 as amended by law 3879/2010, article 28, par. 1). An allowance of 300 Euros is granted per year and for annual family income up to 3.000 Euros.

6.7 Treatment of special groups

The amounts of family allowances increase by 1,83 € per month and by 22,02 € per year for each child in the following cases:

- a) For not recognized children born out of marriage
- b) For children with disabilities
- c) For parentless orphans
- d) When the beneficiary is a widow
- e) When the beneficiary has a disabled spouse
- f) When the beneficiary's spouse is a soldier

6.7.2. Benefits for the uninsured elderly

With the implementation of the law 4387/2016 (article 93), the Pension for the Uninsured Elderly (law 1296/1982 as it has been amended by the law 4093/2012) has been replaced by the Social Solidarity Benefit for the Uninsured Elderly.

The basic requirements for the Pension for the Uninsured Elderly and also for the Social Solidarity Benefit for the Uninsured Elderly are the following:

1. The beneficiaries must be over the age of 67.
2. The recipients' annual personal taxable income cannot exceed 4,320 € and the annual family taxable income cannot exceed 8,640 €.

The full amount of the Social Solidarity Benefit for the Uninsured Elderly remains the same as the amount of Pension for the Uninsured Elderly, 360 €.

Changes in eligibility criteria have been introduced in the following:

1. The benefit may be granted to the elderly who do not fulfill the necessary requirements for a pension.
2. The benefit may also be granted to the elderly who do receive a pension from a pension fund abroad, but the full amount of that pension is smaller than the amount of the Social Solidarity Benefit for the Uninsured Elderly. In that case, the amount of the pension they receive from abroad is deducted from the full amount of the benefit (360 €) and they are granted the remaining sum. The minimum amount of the benefit is 20 €.
3. Beneficiaries who receive pensions from abroad, in order to be entitled to the Social Solidarity Benefit for the Uninsured Elderly, must reside permanently and legally in Greece for fifteen (15) consecutive years, before the application for the benefit or for

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fifteen (15) years between the 17th and the 67th year of age and, from that period of time, the ten (10) years must be consecutive before the application for the benefit. Also, beneficiaries must continue to reside in Greece after they receive the benefit.

4. The full amount of the benefit is granted to those who meet the criteria mentioned above and additionally, have a residence period of 35 years at least. Otherwise, the benefit decreases by 1/35 for each year lacking until the completion of the required 35 years.
5. The objective value of their assets cannot exceed, for real estate property, the sum of 90,000 € and for any type of automobile the sum of 6,000 €.
6. The uninsured elderly whose spouse receives pension from any pension fund and the amount is larger than 360 € are excluded from the benefit.

The criteria for the Pension for the Uninsured Elderly determined that beneficiaries must have a residence period of twenty (20) years in the country and that do not receive or are entitled to receive in the future any type of pension from Greece or abroad, regardless of the amount.

Beneficiaries who were granted the Pension for the Uninsured Elderly before the implementation of the law 4387/2016 (May 12th 2016), continue to receive their pension after that date without any alteration in the amount, the criteria, etc.

The benefit for the uninsured elderly as well as the Pension for the Uninsured Elderly are paid by OGA (Agricultural Insurance Organisation), funded by the budget of that organisation.

7 Child care benefits

Pursuant to Law No.4144, GGI 88/18-4-2013 (Ch. 2. article 25, par. 1), the Manpower Employment Organization (OAED) is responsible, inter alia, for providing childcare facilities to working people, through its day nurseries. More specifically, the OAED operates twenty-four (24) day nurseries, of which eight (8) are located in the Prefecture of Attica and sixteen (16) in other Regions.

The OAED day nurseries operate in privately-owned buildings of the Organization, observing all modern safety, hygiene and functionality standards of pre-school settings. Their technical infrastructure is in line with modern pedagogical requirements, effectively supporting all relevant pedagogical programs and events. Their working hours are from 6.45 a.m. to 16.00 p.m., from September to July (they are closed in August).

The OAED day nurseries cater for preschool children (from eight months to school age) whose parents are entitled to OAED benefits and allowances. The Organization's selection criteria are both social (families with more than three children, orphans, children of single-parent families, disabled children) and economic (children of low-income parents are prioritized).

Through the operation of Day Nurseries, OAED aims to contribute to preschool education, covering the needs of its beneficiaries to the extent possible. At the same time, it aims to help women participate as much as possible in the economic and social life of Greece.

– In 2016-2017, 1,303 infants and children were catered for.

– 130 educators and 98 other staff members are employed at the OAED day nurseries.

– For the year 2016, the operating costs of the OAED Day Nurseries (catering, cleaning materials, exceptional costs) amounted to €732,325.00, which were covered through OAED's own resources.

7.1 Out-of-pocket childcare fees paid by parents

As far as the imposition of catering fees for the municipal day nurseries is concerned, it is provided for by the provisions of article 9 of the Model Regulation for the Operation of Municipal Day and Infant Nurseries (Joint Ministerial Decision No.16065/22-4-2002, O.G.B'497), in accordance with which the Administrative Board of the legal entity – following a fully documented consent of the relevant Local Self-Government Agency (OTA), which is in conformity with the social nature of the services provided – may define the criteria for the imposition of a monthly payment (catering fees) to the families of the hosted children, depending on their financial state. The same Administrative Board decision defines the cases of families that may be exempted from the payment of this financial contribution, or that may make reduced payments.

It is noted that the decision to impose catering fees is subsumed in the framework of the OTA and their respective legal entities' financial and administrative independence.

The Nurseries that take into account the family income, in order to determine the amount to be paid as catering fees, use many different scales regarding both the income and the fees.

As far as the amount of paid catering fees per parents' income scale is concerned, there are variations regarding the amount of catering fees imposed by Crèches [Day Nurseries] and Infant Nurseries, not only among income categories, but also within the same category, and the fees vary from 30 Euros up to more than 80 Euros.

In order to improve the living conditions of the children and the standards of services offered, parents pay catering expenses depending on their family income.

Table : Catering expenses (in €) in 2008

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Family income (in €)	Catering expenses (in €)*
Up to 5.898,4	Free
5.898,41 – 8.804,11	20,54
8.804,11 – 11.738,81	26,41
11.738,81 – 14.673,51	35,22
14.673,51 – 17.608,22	44,02
17.608,22 – 20.542,92	52,82
Over 20.542,92	64,56

* half expenses are paid for the second child.

Families with more than three children and parents with disabilities (more than 67%) are exempt from the obligation to pay catering expenses when their income is up to 20.542,92€ (when the income is more than 20.542,92€, the expenses for the third child are 20,54€ and 10,27€ for every child beyond the third one). It is not always mean-tested.

7.2 Child-care benefits

By virtue of para5 of article 1 of Act3296/2004, the tax relief of 15% on the expenses for Day and Infant Nurseries has been repealed.

8 Allowances depending on employment

None.

9 Allowances for single-parent families

There is a fixed allowance for children without financial support. Please, refer to family allowances.

10 Tax system

10.1 Income tax planning

10.1.1 Tax allowances and credits

10.1.1.1 Standard tax reliefs

Social security contributions: all compulsory social security contributions and optional contributions to legally constituted funds are fully deductible from taxable gross income.

10.1.1.2. Tax credits

Deductions from the payable amount of tax, as calculated on the basis of the scale (Non-Standard tax credits):

By virtue of article 16, para.1 of Act No. 4172/2013 (Income Tax Code), as in force after being replaced by the provisions of Act No 4387/2016, the tax arising by the tax scale for employees and pensioners is reduced as following:

- by EUR 1900 for annual income up to EUR 20 000, for taxpayers with no dependent children;
- by EUR 1950 for annual income up to EUR 20000 for taxpayers with one dependent child;
- by EUR 2000 for annual income up to EUR 20000 for taxpayers with two dependent children;
- by EUR 2100 for annual income up to EUR 20000 for taxpayers with 3 dependent children or more;
- for income exceeding EUR 20 000, the above mentioned tax credit is being reduced by EUR 10 for every EUR 1000 of taxable income.

In order to maintain the tax reduction under this Article, the taxpayer is required to make purchases of goods and receive services within the country or in Member States of the European Union or EEA, which have been paid electronically, the minimum amount of which is determined as a percentage of the taxable income according to the following scale:

Income (Euro)	Minimum spending rate
1-10.000	10%
10.000-30.000	15%
30.000,01 και above	20% and up to 30.000 Euro

If not covered the minimum amount of the aforesaid scale, then the tax is increased by the amount resulting from the positive difference between the required and the stated amount, multiplied by a rate of twenty-two percent (22%). Exempted from the obligation to use electronic means of payment and produce evidence of making expenditures are taxpayers seventy (70) years or older, people with a disability of eighty percent (80%) and above, those who are in judicial support, tax residents of EU or EEA, Foreign Ministry officials, the military, if serving abroad, those serving in the Permanent Greek Delegation of the European Union, those who reside in a nursing home, psychiatric centres and prisoners.

10.1.1.3. Other deductions

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The following tax credits are deducted from the payable amount of tax, as calculated on the basis of the scale after applying the above tax allowance:

- 10% of the expenses of medical and hospital care of the taxpayer and his/her dependents provided they are not covered by Social Security Funds and they exceed 5% of the taxable income. The total credit cannot exceed EUR 3000.
- 10% of the expenses of medical and hospital care of the taxpayer and his dependents, provided they are not covered by Social Security Funds and they exceed 5% of the taxable income. The total credit cannot exceed EUR 3 000. Hospital expenses in respect of unmarried or widowed children who suffer from an incurable disease, who are mentally retarded or are blind and whose total annual income does not exceed EUR 6 000 are also included.
- Amounts paid by the taxpayers as donations. The total amount of donations on which the reduction is calculated may not exceed (10%) of the total donated amount. The list of institutions to receive donations from donors, for the application of the above provision is pending. The amount of tax derived on the basis of all scales is reduced by EUR 200 for the taxpayer himself as well as for each dependent member, provided that the taxpayer or his dependents are handicapped (over 67 %) or handicapped soldiers or military personnel injured in the course of their duties or war victims or victims of terrorist attacks or in case they receive pension by the State as war victims or as handicapped.

Note: Taxpayers who reside abroad but derive taxable income from sources in Greece are not eligible for these deductions, with the exemptions of residents of the EU Member States who derive at least 90% of their total income from sources in Greece.

Spouses:

When the wife derives income taxable on the basis of the scale, then the following are deducted from her own payable amount of tax:

- a) deductions related to medical and hospital expenses, donations and the lump sum of EUR 200 of the spouse;
- b) deductions related to medical and hospital expenses of the spouse's children from a former marriage, her children born out of wedlock, her parents and orphaned relatives of first and second degree of kin.

10.1.1.4 Exemptions

Some forms of income, specified by Law are exempt from the tax.

Examples:

- on condition of reciprocity, income of all kinds derived abroad by foreign ambassadors and diplomatic representatives, consulate agents and employees of embassies and consulates that have the nationality of the represented State as well as by individuals working in the EU Institutions or other International Organizations;
- alimony received by the beneficiary according to the Court adjudication or notary Document;
- all forms of pensions and relief provided to war victims and their families, as well as to soldiers and military personnel injured in the course of their duties in times of peace;
- benefits and similar allowances provided to special categories of handicapped people;

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- salaries, pensions, etc. paid to handicapped people (over 80 %);
- unemployment benefits granted by the National Employment Organisation (OAED) provided that the total annual income of the beneficiary does not exceed the amount of EUR 10 000;
- the social solidarity benefit (E.K.A.S.) of pensioners;
- financial aid to recognized political refugees, to people residing temporarily in Greece for humanitarian reasons and to persons that have submitted the relevant application to the competent Greek authorities, paid by bodies carrying out refugee aid schemes financed by the UN and the EU;
- the benefit for hazardous labour provided to employees working in the armed forces, the police, the fire and port departments as well as the special allowance to medical, nursing and ambulance staff up to 65%.

10.1.2 *Definition of taxable income*

Taxable income is derived from the following sources:

- a) Income from employment and pensions
- b) Income from business activities, which also includes income from self-employed
- c) Income from agricultural activities
- d) Rental Income
- e) Investment income which includes income from dividends, interests and royalties and
- f) Income from capital gains, which includes income deriving on transfer of real estate or securities.

Net income is computed separately within each category with tax rules that vary across income categories. If the declared income is not accepted as the base for the tax assessment, the tax authorities can base the assessment on the presumptive income, which is the minimum amount of income required to cover the taxpayer's main living expenses.

Employment income is subject to withholding tax. The tax is withheld by the employer and is calculated by applying the taxpayer's progressive income tax scale. The employer calculates the withholding tax on the basis of the taxpayer's annual net salary (net of social security contributions). The withholding tax is then reduced by 1.5 per cent of the total amount of taxes due. The resulting tax is the annual tax due, 1/14 of which constitutes the monthly withholding tax for the private sector's employees (every employee receives 14 monthly salaries per year, i.e. 12 monthly wages plus 1 salary as Christmas bonus, ½ salary as Easter bonus and ½ salary as summer vacation bonus). For the employees of the public sector, the monthly withholding tax is calculated approximately as 1/12 of the annual tax due. If the taxpayer's final tax liability (derived from the annual declared income) exceeds the aggregate of the amounts already withheld or prepaid, the remaining tax is generally payable in three equal bimonthly instalments. Any excess tax paid or withheld will be refunded.

10.1.3 *Tax scale*

Depending on the income category the following tax schedules apply:

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Income from employment and pensions is pooled together with income from business activity and is taxed at the following rates:

Income bracket (EUR)	Tax rate (%)	Tax bracket (EUR)	Total amount	
			Income (EUR)	Tax (EUR)
20 000	22%	4 400	20 000	4 400
10 000	29%	2 900	30 000	7 300
10 000	37%	3 700	40 000	11 000
Excess	45%			

The above tax scale does not apply for employment income acquired by:

- Officers working in ships of the merchant marine, whose income is taxed at a 15% flat rate and
- Low-income crew working in ships of the merchant marine, whose income is taxed at a 10% flat rate.

Income from agricultural business is taxed separately but with the same tax schedule. The previously described tax credit is granted to farmers as well. In the case where a farmer is earning income from employment / pension, only one tax credit is given.

Rental Income is taxed at the following rates:

Income	Tax Rate
0 – 12.000	15%
12.001 – 35.000	35%
>35.000	45%

10.1.4 *Special solidarity contribution*

Solidarity contribution (which was first introduced by Art. 29 of Law 3986/2011) is now included in the Income Tax Code (Law 4172/2013) with a separate article (art 43A) after being amended by the provisions of Law 4387/2016. Income up to EUR 12 000 is not subject to solidarity contribution. For income exceeding EUR 12 000, solidarity contribution applies with the following marginal rates:

"Solidarity Contribution Marginal Tax Rates

Income	Tax Rate
0 – 12.000	0%
12.001 - 20.000	2,2%
20.001 - 30.000	5,00%
30.001 - 40.000	6,50%
40.001 - 65.000	7,50%
65.001 - 220.000	9,00%
>220.000	10,00%

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The following categories are excluded and disregarded income for the imposition of the special solidarity contribution:

- Income of persons who are totally blind and persons with severe motor disabilities at a rate of 80% and more,
- compensation for termination of employment relationship,
- lump-sum benefits paid by welfare funds and insurance organizations and lump-sums paid as financial aids to long term unemployment people.

10.2 Treatment of family income

Married persons (spouses) are taxed separately on their own separate income, but are required to submit a joint tax return.

10.3 Social insurance contribution scale

The average contributions rate paid by workers and employers to social insurance bodies is calculated on their gross income as follows:

	Employer	Employee	Total
1. Social Insurance Organisation (IKA)	17.88	9.22	27.10
2. Subsidiary Social Insurance Fund (ETEA)	3.50	3.50	7.00
3. Other Funds	3.68	3.28	6.96
Total	25.06	16.00	40.06

Contributions are calculated on the basis of the monthly salary or wages paid but within the limits specified in the National General Collective Employment Agreement. Monthly gross remuneration includes salaries and wages, fringe benefits and bonuses and any profit distributions to employees. A ceiling of EUR 2 432.25 per month applies for individuals who have started working prior to 1-1-1993 (2010-ceiling). On the other hand, for individuals who have started working after 1-1-1993, the social security contributions ceiling is EUR 5 546.80. It should be noted that since 01.01.2013 there is a unique ceiling set for both categories of employees and it amounts to 5 546.80 euro.

The aforementioned rates and earnings are also taken into account for the calculation of the contributions on Christmas and Easter bonuses, as well as on the holiday bonus, on which separate contributions are paid to IKA-ETAM.

Contribution rates paid by employees and employers to social insurance funds as a percentage on their income are as follows for those insured **after 1-1-1993**:

1. ETAA

- ETAA-TSMEDE (mainly engineers etc.): 30% on their monthly salary, (13.33% employer, 6.67% employee, 10% as state finance.
- ETAA-TSAY (mainly doctors, pharmacists and medical personnel): 30% on their monthly salary, (13.33% employer, 6.67% employee, 10% as state finance.
- ETAA-TAN (lawyers, notaries etc.): 30% on their monthly salary, (13.33% employer, 6.67% employee, 10% as state finance.

* Since 1-1-2013, a monthly salary ceiling of EUR 5 546.80 applies for individuals insured in ETAA.

*There is also a minimum level of monthly salary of EUR 693.35 (equivalent to the 1st Insurance Category) for all three Funds consisting ETAA (TSMEDE, TSAY and TAN).

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2. **OGA** for employee - unskilled worker in the agricultural field: 14% calculated on the 5th Insurance Category (7% contribution financed by the State + 7% paid by the employer). For the self-employed the contribution is 10% X amount corresponding to the insurance class of the insured.

For those insured up to 31-12-1992:

ETAA-TSMEDE: 20% on their monthly salary (13.33% for the employer and 6.67% for the employee).

** A monthly salary ceiling of EUR 5 546.80 applies for those insured in ETAA-TSMEDE only, insured up to 31-12-1992.*

ETAA-TSAY: A fixed contribution that cannot be less than 20% on the 1st Insurance Category (currently, Euro 188) for the employee + 13.33% on the salary for the employer.

ETAA-TAN: 42% of the contribution paid by self-employed lawyer.

1. **OAAE (mainly craftsmen, retailers, hotel owners etc.)**: 20% on the 14 existing Insurance Categories (of which the first 10 are obligatory) + 10% as state finance.
2. **OGA**: 7% on the 7 existing Insurance Categories (of which the first 5 are obligatory) + a fixed amount equivalent to 2.05 EUR (for the 1st-4th Insurance Category) and 3.08 EUR (for the 5th -7th Insurance Category) for LAE (Agricultural Account) + 14% as state finance.
3. ETAA for those insured after 1-1-1993:

ETAA-TSMEDE: 20% on the Insurance Category in which they are classified + 10% on the Insurance Category as state finance.

ETAA-TSAY: 20% on the Insurance Category in which they are classified + 10% on the Insurance Category as state finance.

ETAA-TAN: 20% on the Insurance Category in which they are classified + 10% on the Insurance Category as state finance.

**Since 1/7/2011, the transition from one Insurance Category to the next takes place every 3 years.*

ETAA For those insured up to 31-12-1992:

ETAA-TSMEDE: A fixed 20% on the amount of the 1st Insurance Category.

ETAA-TSAY: a fixed amount which cannot be less than 20% on the amount of the 1st Insurance Category (currently, EUR 188.30).

ETAA-TAN: a fixed amount which cannot be less than 20% on the amount of the 1st Insurance Category (currently, EUR 146.82).

** Since 1/7/2011 there is also an additional contribution of 2% on the 1st Insurance Category (EUR 13.86) for all individuals insured up to 31-12-1992 in ETAA.*

** There is also an unemployment monthly contribution of EUR 10 for all self-employed insured in ETAA and OAAE for both individuals who have started working after 1-1-1993 and those prior to 1-1-1993.*

Starting with 1st of July 2015, by the article 1 par. 31 of the Law 4334/2015 (Gazette 80 A), the contribution rate withheld from primary pensions for healthcare of pensioners is increased from 4% to 6%, and also, the 6% healthcare contribution withheld from supplementary pensions is established.

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10.4 Scale of social insurance contributions to health bodies:

Persons insured with health bodies are divided into the old insured and the new insured, depending on the date on which they started paying contributions calculated on their remuneration, as follows:

1. **The old insured** are the persons firstly insured by 31-12-1992, and
2. **The new insured** are the persons firstly insured after 01-01-1993.

Pursuant to Act No2084/1992, a unified rate of contributions to illness – maternity insurance has been established for all wage earners and self-employed persons, as follows:

- Wage earners - 2,55%, and
- Self-employed persons - 7,65% or 6,45%, depending on the insurance category, to which they belong.

The rate of contributions to bodies, with which self-employed persons are insured and **which do not grant illness benefits in cash**, is set at 6,45%.

In case the rate of contributions to health bodies and illness sectors was larger before the promulgation of Act No.2084/1992, the larger rate continues to be paid for both the old and the new insured.

The contributions paid for the year 2010 to the ETAA - Unified Fund for the Independently Employed (with which physicians, lawyers, engineers, notaries are insured) are the same as those for the previous year, as follows:

1st	693.35euro
2nd	852.63euro
3rd	1,010.86euro
4th	1,168.60euro
5th	1,319.65euro
6th	1,435.66euro
7th	1,547.81euro
8th	1,659.99euro
9th	1,772.15euro
10th	1,884.34euro
11th	1,996.51euro
12th	2,108.67euro
13th	2,220.85euro
14th	2,333.02euro

The contributions for both the old and the new insured with the OAEE – Insurance Organization for Freelancers for the year 2010 are the same as those for the previous year, as follows:

1st	762.04euro
2nd	930.71euro
3rd	1,111.02euro
4th	1,212.92euro
5th	1,399.06euro
6th	1,577.93euro
7th	1,687.28euro
8th	1,824.48euro
9th	1,947.75euro
10th	2,071.08euro
11th	2,194.35euro

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12th	2,317.62euro
13th	2,440.96euro
14th	2,564.24euro

11. Part-time employment

11.1 *Special rules governing financial assistance to the part-time employed*

The part-time employment scheme under Act No. 3250/2004 was concluded in 2012. No change to the institutional framework governing the part-time employees was made for as long as it lasted within that year.

11.2 *Special rules concerning taxation and social contributions regarding part-time employment*

None.

12 Policy development

12.1 Policy changes introduced: 2nd July 2015 – 1st July 2016

- Tax brackets and tax rates of personal income tax were revised.
- Eligibility rules and the amounts of employment income tax credit changed: now the full amount of tax credit depends on family composition.
- Solidarity contributions were revised (both bands and rates). The tax is applied progressively (previously applied as a simple tax).
- In addition: Article 235 of Law 4389/2016 (O.G.94/A) provides for the gradual implementation at national level of the programme “Social Solidarity Income” aiming at combating extreme poverty. The programme is structured on three (3) pillars that include income support, promotion and guarantee of access to social services and goods as well as actions for integration and reintegration into the labour market. The programme was originally implemented in 30 Municipalities of the country from 14-07-2016 till 31-12-2016, in accordance with the provisions of Joint Ministerial Decision NoD23/30299/2377 (O.G.2089/B) and has been extended till 31/01/2017 by virtue of article 55 of Law 4449/2017 (O.G.7/A).

12.2 Future policy changes announced since 1st July 2016

- By virtue of article 235 of Law 4389/2016 (O.G.94/A), as it was amended by article 22 of Law 4445/2016 (O.G.236/A) and Joint Ministerial Decision NO2961/10 (O.G.128/B), the programme “Social Solidarity Income” has been implemented throughout the country since 01/02/2017.
- Programme for financial aid of University students belonging to Special Social Groups and have low incomes aiming the timely completion of their studies.

The action / program concerns the financial aid of University students belonging to Special Social Groups and / or have low incomes in order to strengthen and support the timely completion of their studies, ensuring in this context the equal participation in Higher Education of disabled persons and persons belonging to vulnerable social groups.

Beneficiaries of the action are students and undergraduate students studying at Higher Education Institutions in Greece, (students attending Military and Police Academies and Schools in the Merchant Marine Academy and the Fire are excluded).

The total budget of the first course of action to be implemented during the academic year 2016-17 is € 12.803.681, of which € 12.603.681 related to the funding of grants and € 200,000 the necessary costs of the beneficiary for the implementation action. The first course of action will concern the granting of 2,700 scholarships.

The amount of each scholarship, including legal deductions, amounts to: 4.668,03 € per student provided that the University is located outside the principal place of residence for themselves and / or their family or outside the place where they themselves or their family real property. €3.734,46 per student studying in university, in those cases that the University is located in the principal place of residence for themselves and / or their family or in the place where they themselves or their family real property.

The programme is initiated the 2nd half of 2016 and the call for proposal opened at the beginning of 2017. The program is co-financed by National resources and the ESF.

Reference date for all information is **July 1st 2016**

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- On 19th of May 2017, Law 4472/2017 was introduced in which changes on the Tax System are included, concerning: the Tax Credit of par.10.1.1.2 (date of entry into force: 01/01/2020), Other Tax Credits of par. 10.1.1.3. (date of entry into force: 01/01/2017), Tax scale of par.10.1.3. (Date of entry into force: 01/01/2020), Social Security Contribution Rates of par.10.1.4. (Date of entry into force: 01/01/2020).

ANNEX

Benefits related to child birth

1 Pregnancy and post-natal period benefit

During maternity leave, women employees receive the benefit from:

- a) the insurance fund that they are insured with
- b) the Hellenic Manpower Employment Organization (OAED) and
- c) their employer.

a) During the maternity leave, women are paid by the Social Insurance Institute. The IKA-ETAM subsidizes the women directly insured with it for 56 days before the presumed date of confinement (pregnancy benefit) and for 63 days after it (post-natal period benefit), i.e. for a total of 119 days (17 weeks), according to the provisions of article 11 of Act No2874/2000 (O.G. 286/A'). During this maternity leave, the insured woman is granted 50% of the presumptive daily wage of the insurance class to which she belongs, on the basis of the average earnings of the last 30 days of the previous year, as well as the child benefit (10% for each child and up to 40% maximum). In this case, the minimum amount of the benefit equals to the 2/3 of the insured woman's earnings and the maximum amount of the mentioned benefit.

b) The Greek Manpower Employment Organisation pays a supplementary amount to ensure the mother's income reaches the level before the leave. This benefit is also granted to all foreign mothers who fulfil the above-mentioned preconditions and legally reside in Greece.

c) Additionally, they receive an amount from their employer that corresponds to fifteen-day wages or one monthly salary, depending on their previous service to this employer; the employer is entitled to deduct from the said benefit any amount the employed woman may receive from her insurance fund as a subsidy for the same period of time.

By the article 6 of the law 4097/2012 (Gazette 235 A), the article 7 of the EU Directive 2010/41 was incorporated into national law, concerning the pregnancy and post-natal benefit granted to self-employed women.

The Self-employed women directly insured with OAEE, based on the above mentioned law and the Joint Ministerial Decision F. 40035/41931/1653/2015, are granted the maternity benefit of 150 € monthly for the period of four months. Furthermore, a maternity benefit is granted for four months to self-employed women, directly insured with ETAA, amounting to EUR 200 € per month, according to the provisions of the abovementioned law and Joint Ministerial Decision F.10060/15858/606 /2014.

2 Post confinement care benefit

Since 2012, the birth grant is replaced by the lump sum birth grant of €900 for the birth of one child, €1200 € for twins and €1600 for triplets, paid by the EOPYY, provided that delivery occurs without any cost for the Insurance Fund (the grant is paid for expenses incurred for medical services in a private hospital). Benefit for the cost of in vitro fertilisation (paid for each attempt/maximum four times) is also granted according to the above mentioned regulation.

Financial benefits are also granted due to maternity to working women that are not eligible to receive them from the insurance body or are uninsured. The said benefits are granted for a period of six weeks

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prior to the childbirth and aim at securing satisfactory living standards. These benefits amount to 440,20€ (220,10€ before the childbirth and 220,10€ after it paid by municipalities.(Law 1302/82,art4, para5).

3 Special Maternity Leave

By virtue of Act 3655/ 2008, art.142, a special maternity leave was instituted. Mothers insured at the IKA – ETAM and working with a fixed-term or non-fixed-term contract, are entitled to this additional leave. As specified under art.36 Law 3996/2011, the beneficiaries for the special maternity leave, are the private sector employees who earn the minimum benefits of art.9 of the 2004-2005 National General Collective Agreement concerning the child-care leave (reduced-time period).

The additional leave is granted after the end of the maternity leave or the end of the 3.5 months leave granted in substitution of the reduced-time period (child-care leave), according to art.9 of the National General Collective Agreement 2004-2005. The special maternity leave starts the day the maternity leave or the above mentioned child care leave of the 3.5 months ends.

OAED is obligated to pay a monthly benefit to the working mother that equals to the minimum wage as set by the National General Collective Agreement, as well as the proportion of holiday benefits and leave benefits according to the minimum wage.

According to Law 3896/(Article 16) the worker who has obtained a maternity leave /or *special maternity leave* shall be entitled, upon expiry of such leave, to return to her job or to an equivalent post on the same employment terms and conditions and to enjoy any improvement of working conditions, to which she would be entitled during her absence. Additionally the employer cannot deny hiring a woman due to her pregnancy or maternity. Law 3896/2010 (article 20)

Additionally, by Law 3996/2011(Article 36) women that take the special maternity leave are also insured for medical care. Regarding women working part-time for up to four hours per day or up to 13 days per month on average during the six months before their pregnancy leave, the amount paid is half the one mentioned above.